Day 43 - Nottawasaga Bluffs Lookout, Keyhole

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Blue Mountains section · hike 52 · Nottawasaga Bluffs Conservation Area

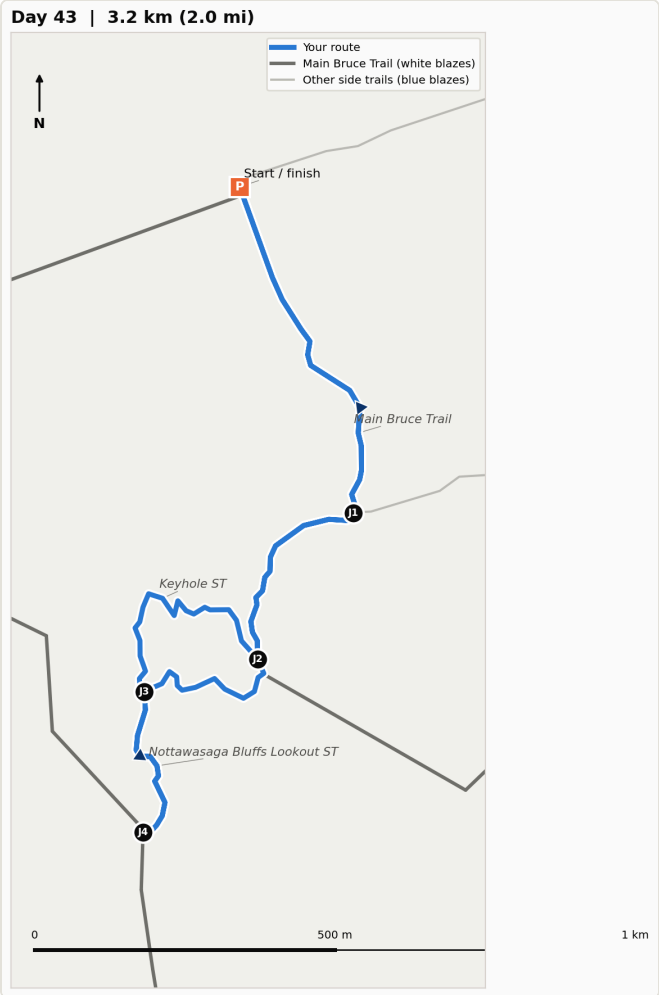
3.2 km / 2.0 mi	~1.0 h	1.0 km new	109 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Accessible only from Con 10 South, this small parking area off 15/16 Sideroad is provided by the Nottawasaga Valley Conservation Authority. Google Maps. **Paid: $15 + HST per vehicle (day)** · scan QR code on site signs or HotSpot app/website; NVCA requires a parking pass at its conservation areas (except Tottenham, New Lowell); this small lot not named specifically; annual pass $70

Navigate: import *day43_hike052.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Nottawasaga Bluffs Lookout Side Trail (0.6 km); Keyhole Side Trail (0.5 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** A small NVCA lot at 8861 Nottawasaga 15/16 Sideroad, open dawn to dusk. A day pass costs $15 + HST per vehicle; buy it through HotSpot or scan the QR code on site. Approach through Singhampton, as the NVCA directs. It warns that map apps may route you along 15/16 Sideroad and Concession 8, which it advises against.
- **Keyhole Side Trail:** Takes you through narrow crevices in the rock, which the NVCA calls an "other-worldly experience." Snow can linger in the crevices into June. Expect tight spots with the dog.
- **Nottawasaga Bluffs Lookout Side Trail:** Leads toward views over the surrounding countryside. The NVCA lists its lookout trail as open only part of the year.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** One loop description notes an old limestone kiln along this stretch.
- **Caution:** The area is a natural hazard area with fissures, crevices and cliffs that can be hidden. Stay on the marked trail. Dogs must be leashed.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Accessible only from Con 10 South, this small parking area off 15/16 Sideroad is provided.... Head south on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.

0.6	0.4	J1: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Betty Carter Side Trail goes off on your left.)
1.0	0.6	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Keyhole Side Trail goes off on your right.) Then, turn right onto the blue-blazed Nottawasaga Bluffs Lookout Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.2	0.8	J3: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Nottawasaga Bluffs Lookout Side Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Keyhole Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.5	1.0	J4: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.8	1.1	J3: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Keyhole Side Trail, heading north. (the Nottawasaga Bluffs Lookout Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
2.3	1.4	J2: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
2.6	1.6	J1: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Betty Carter Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.2	2.0	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the NVCA, Ontario Nature Trails and Trail Run Project.